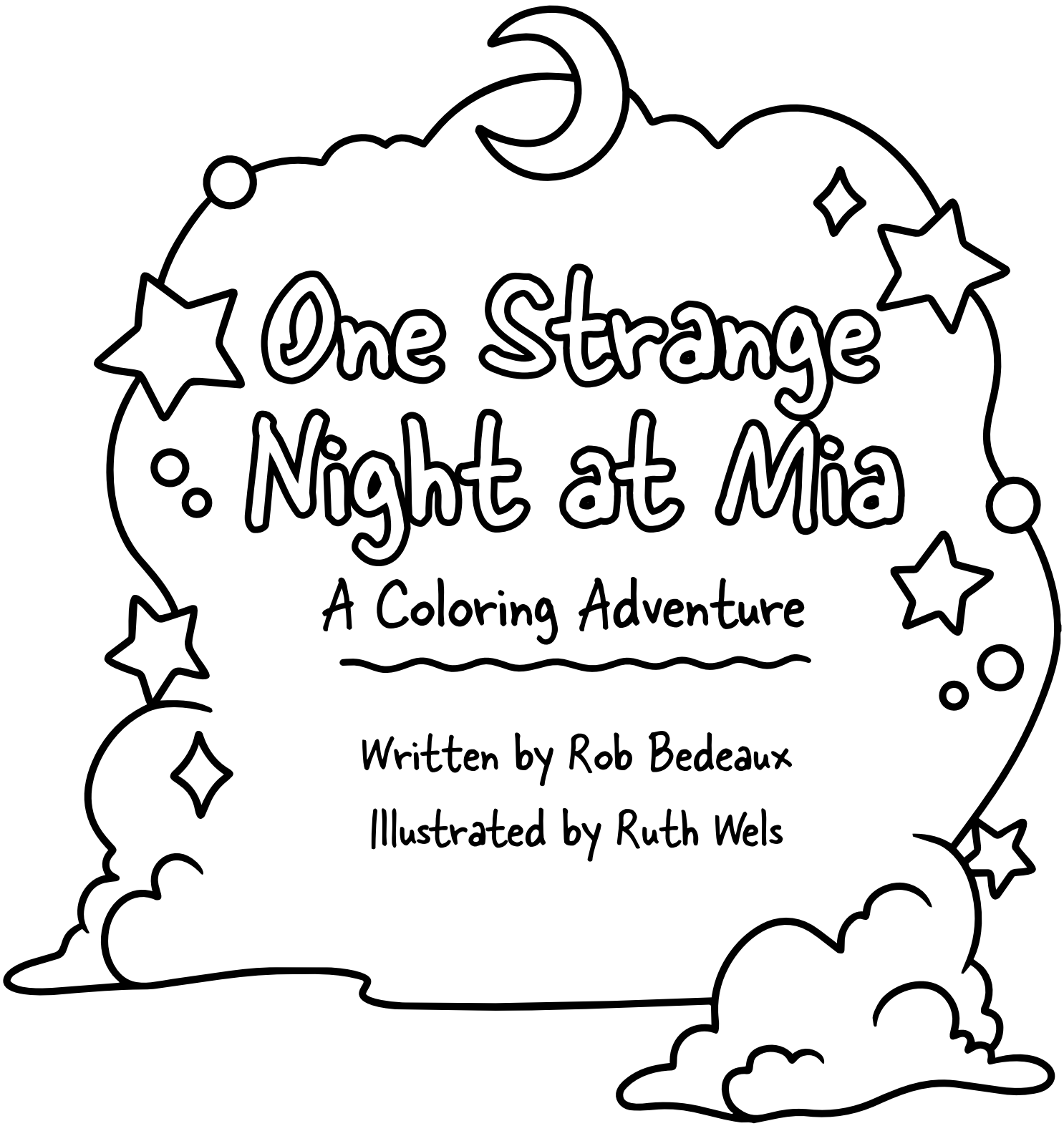
Minneapolis Institute of Art



One Strange Night at Mia

A Coloring Adventure

Illustrated by Ruth Wels


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A Coloring Adventure
Written by Rob Bedeaux
Illustrated by Ruth Wels

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Illustrations © 2026 Ruth Wels
Written by Robert S Bedeaux
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Published by Minneapolis Institute of Art
ISBN: 979-8-99-927140-2
Minneapolis, Minnesota


This coloring adventure belongs to...

Follow the Owl's trail through Mia!

Inspired by: *The Pillsbury Owl, China, 1200s–1100s BCE.*

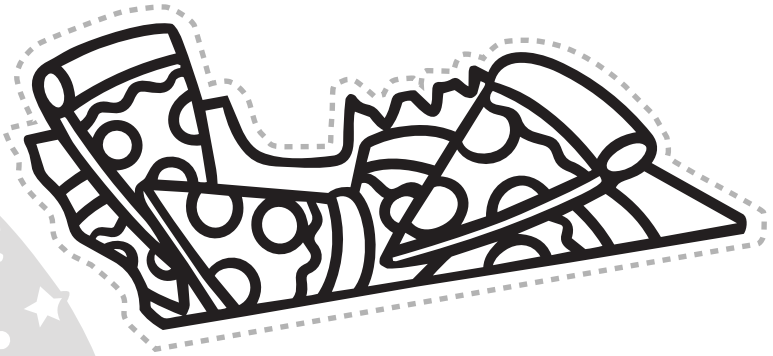


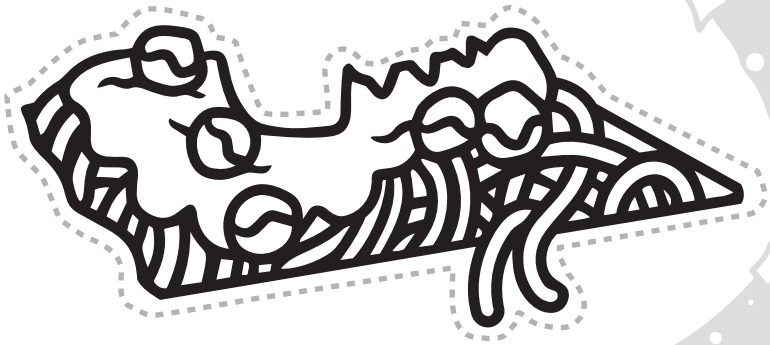
The galleries were still that night.
The halls were dark, but the moon was bright.
Then something strange came into sight—
Mia's Pillsbury Owl had taken flight!

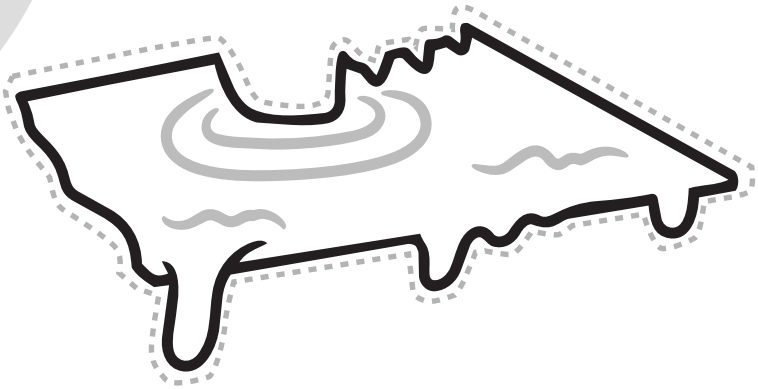
Inspired by: *Philip R. Goodwin, A "Bear" Chance, 1907.*

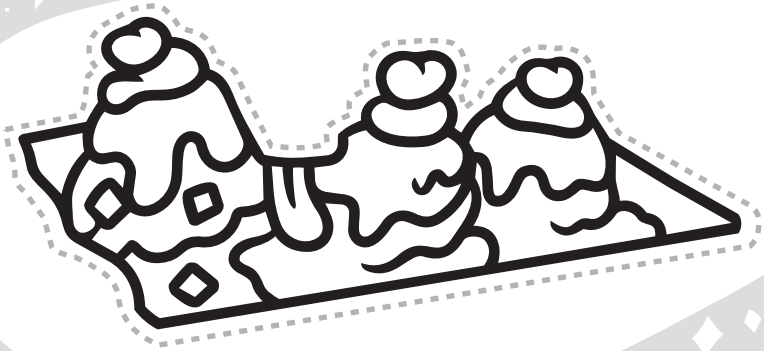


The Owl was curious what he might find
so off he flew, no plan in mind
He flew room to room, until right there
he found a box beside a bear.

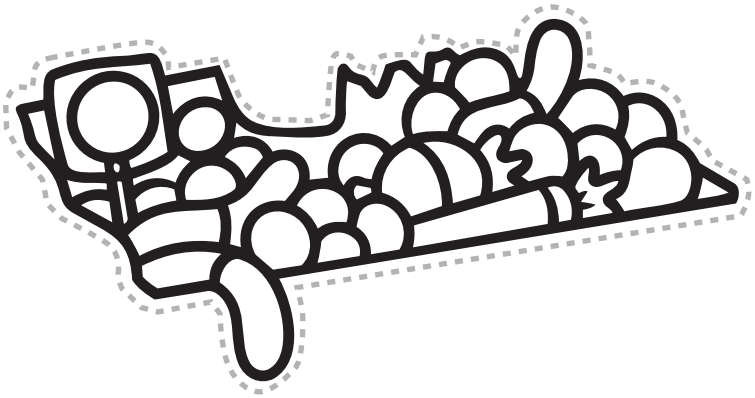












What could be hiding inside?

The Owl looked closely, but said, "You should decide."

Inspired by: *Armor, Germany, about 1520.*



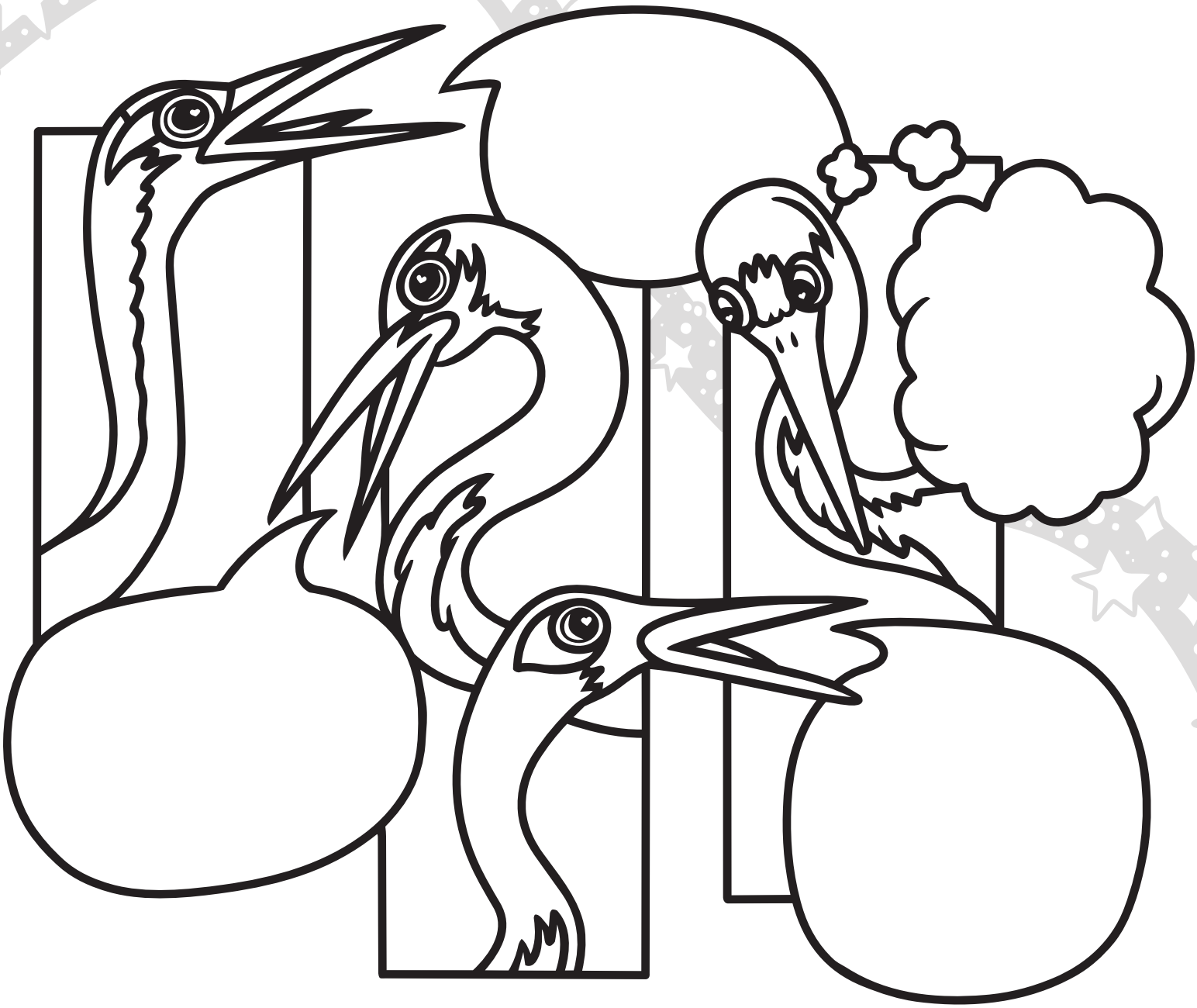
He flew left, he flew right,
and nearly bumped into a knight.
The knight said, "Stop! And go that way!"
So off the little Owl flew way and away.

Inspired by: *Pablo Picasso, Baboon and Young, 1951.*



He flew that way, and very soon,
he heard a mother humming a tune.
She was rocking her baby gently with care,
then mother whispered, "Shhh!" when Owl flew there.

Inspired by a detail from: *Ishida Yūtei, Flock of Cranes, 1700s.*

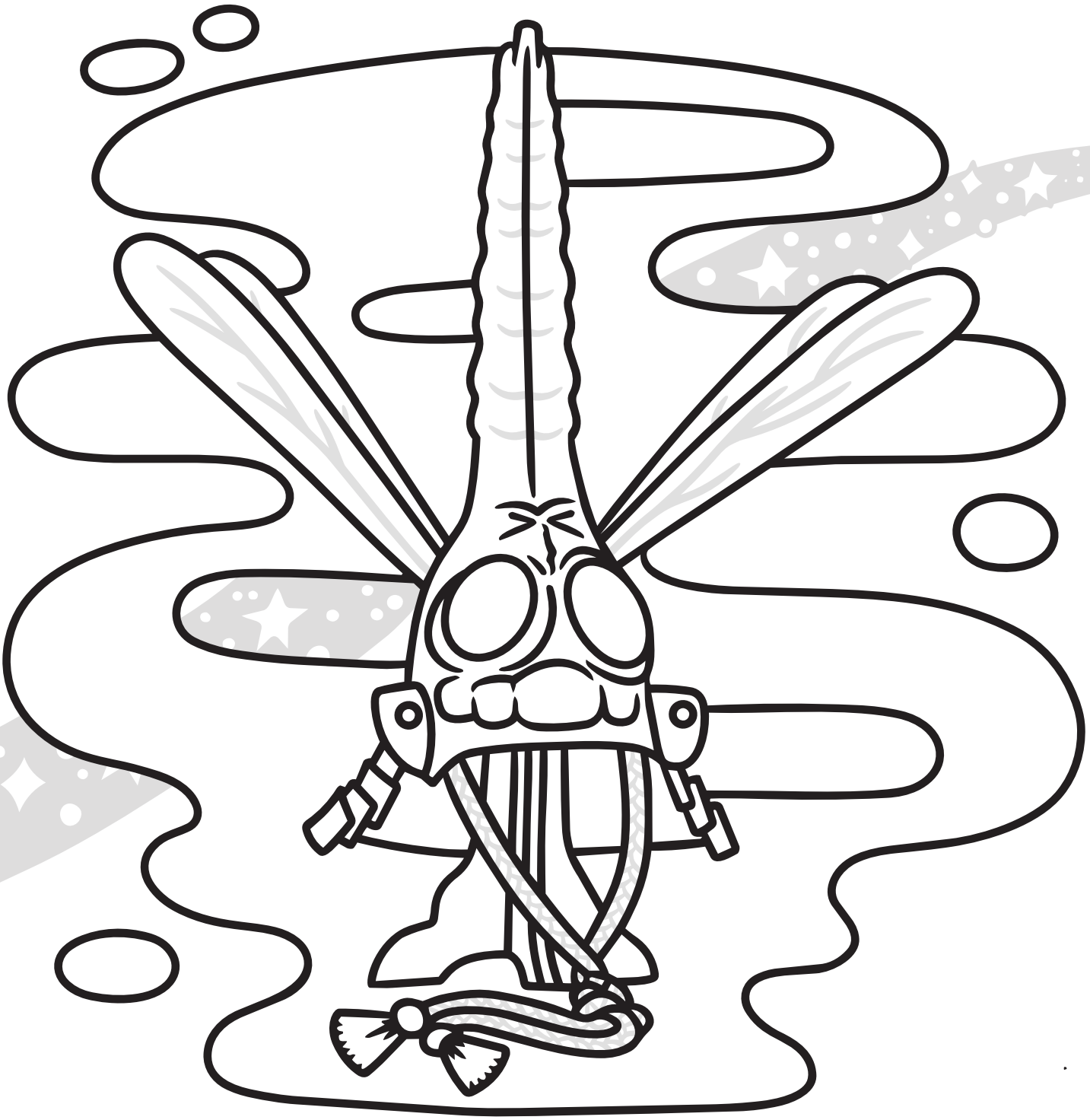


The mother's shush still in his ear,
the Owl flew on so none could hear.
Then all at once, a noisy flock
began to chatter, chirp, and squawk.



Past the flock, a dragonfly
went zipping quickly right on by.
The Owl was curious where it went,
and followed on with full intent.

Inspired by: *Helmet in Dragonfly Shape, Japan, 1600s.*



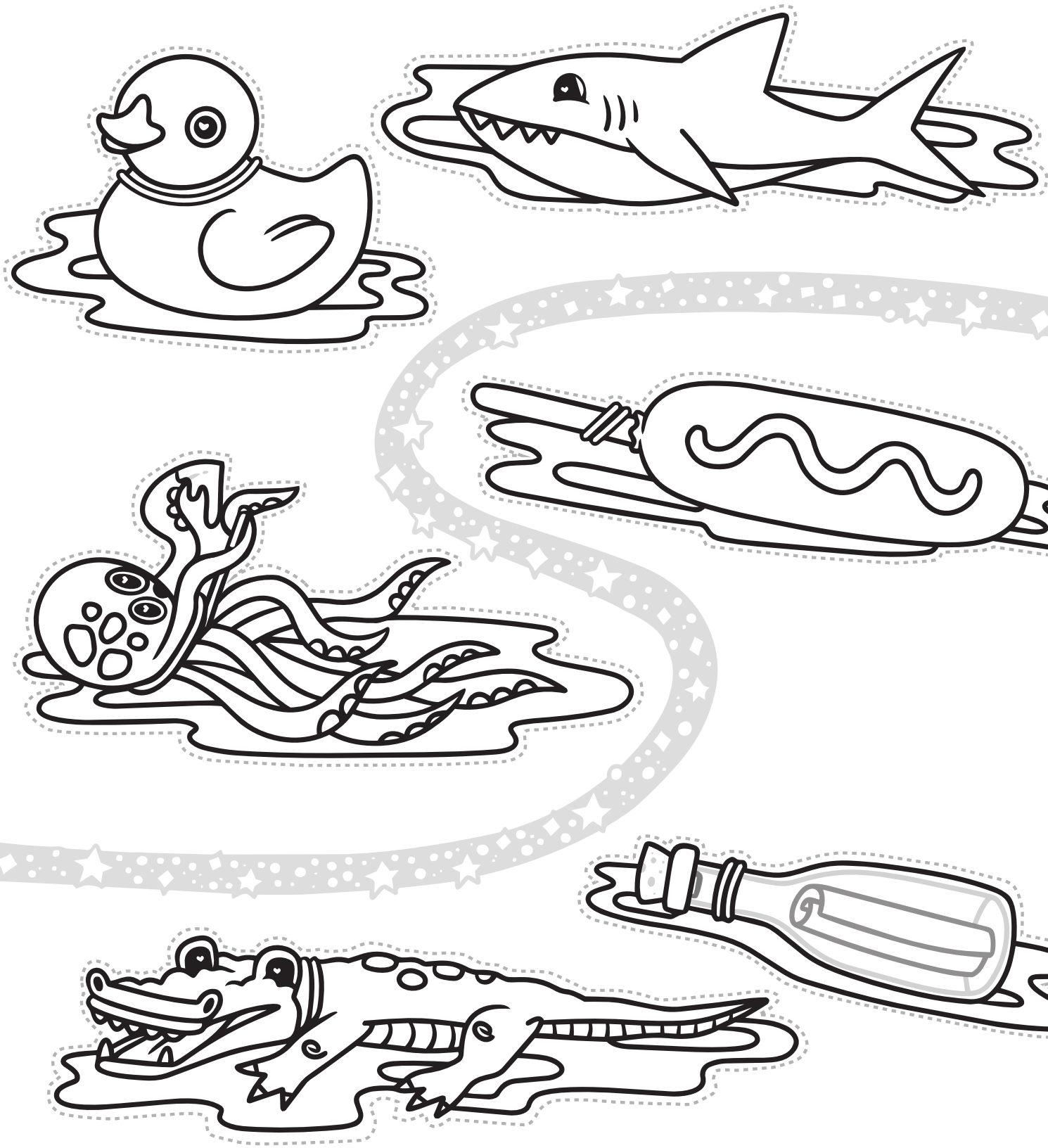
Not so fast! A dragonfly-shaped helmet flew by.
The Owl gave chase and it was a race!
Where could this strange adventure lead?



Inspired by: *Junius Brutus Stearns, A Fishing Party Off Long Island, 1860.*

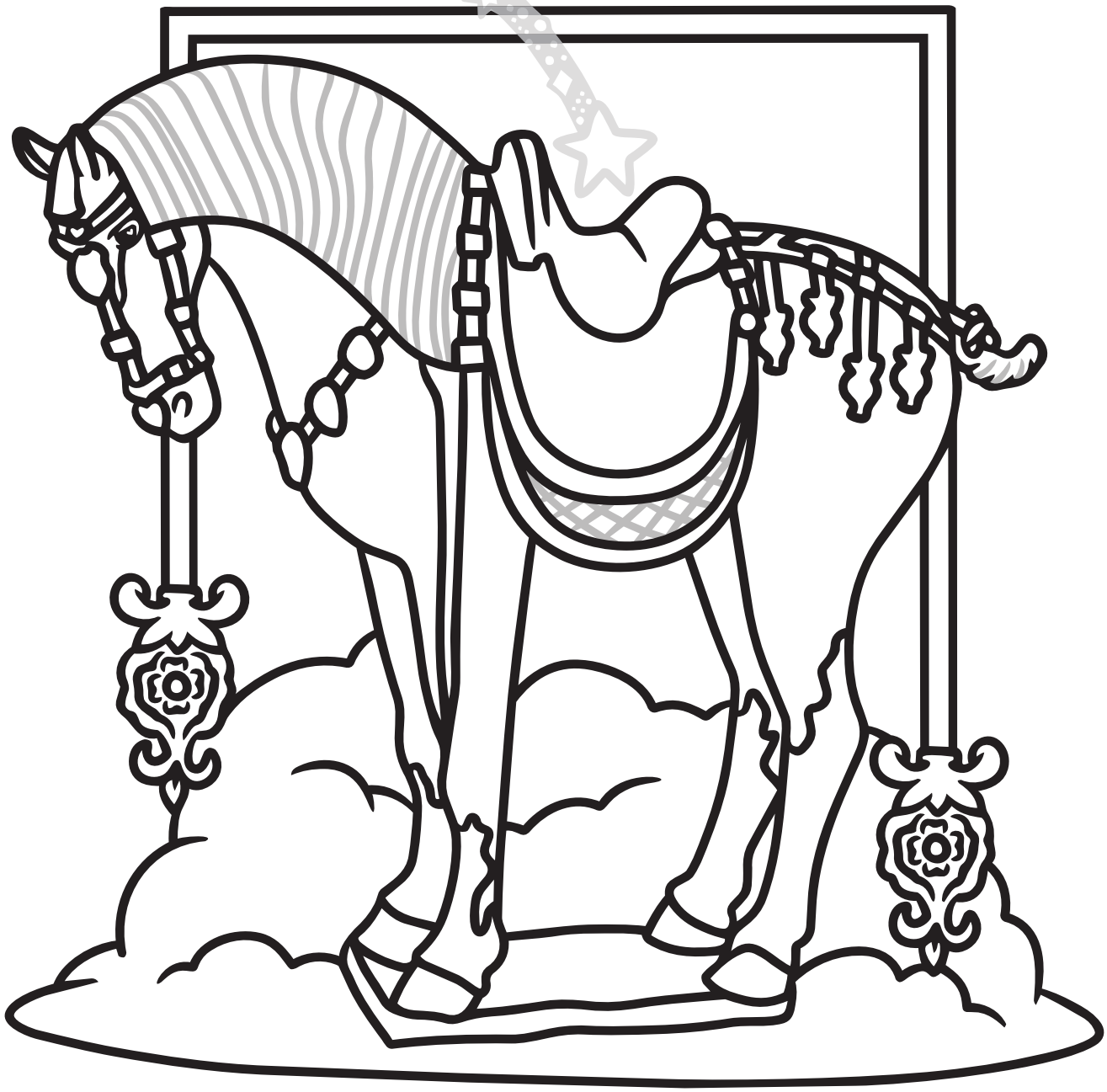


He followed where the dragon flew
and found a fishing party, too.
Their lines went splashing down below...
but what they'd catch, he didn't know.



A fish? A duck? A bottled note?
What did they pull into their boat?
Pick something silly, strange, or new.
What they caught is up to you!

Inspired by: *Horse, China, 700s.*



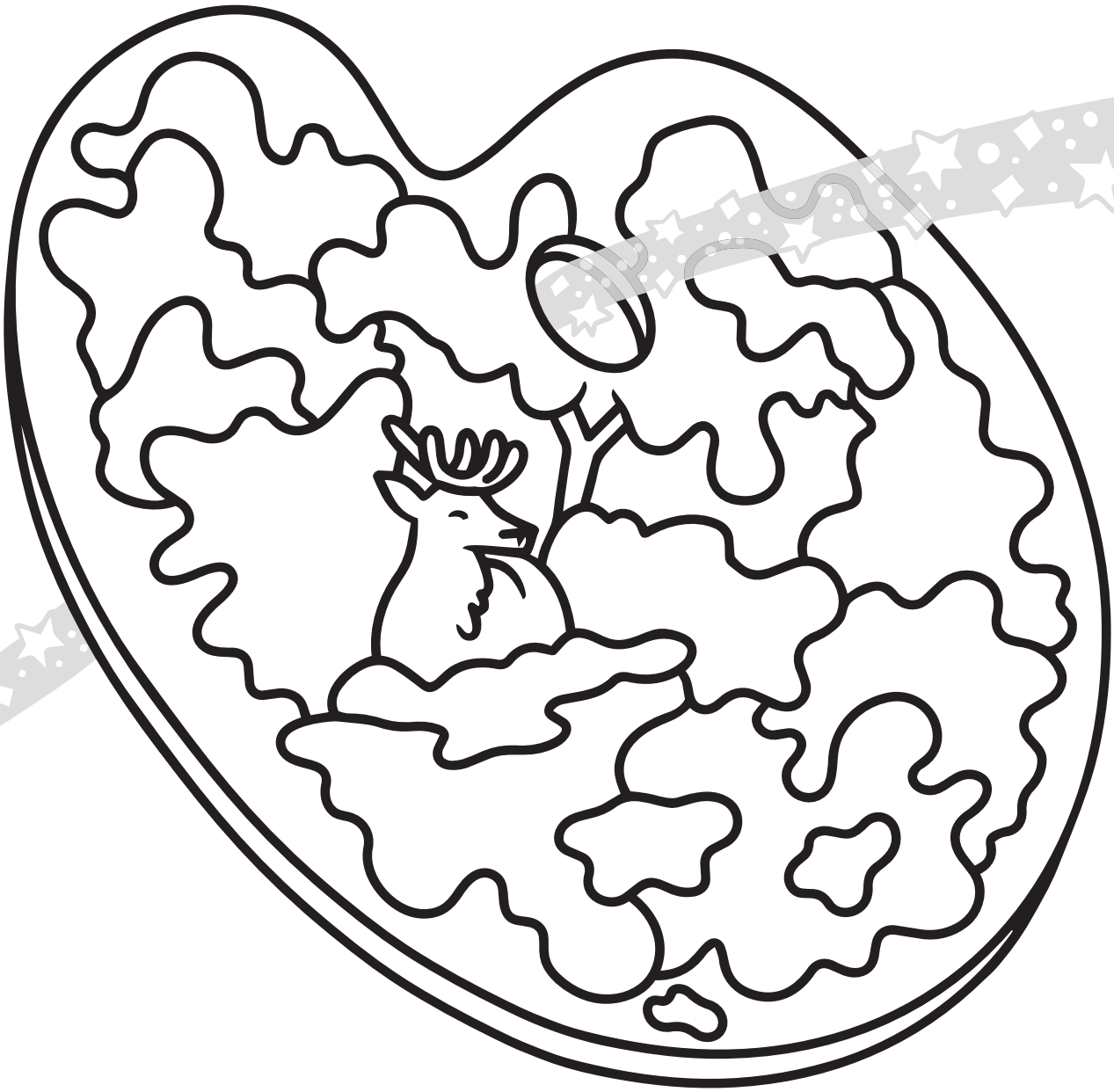
The Owl flew on and soon, of course,
he came upon a splendid horse.
He landed lightly on its back
and cried, "Let's go!" along the track.

Inspired by a detail from: *Jade Mountain, China, 1790.*



The horse sped down the winding way,
past trees and streams without delay.
Through mountains high and valleys low,
they wondered where the path would go.

Inspired by: *Rosa Bonheur, Palette, 1800s.*



At last the horse came to a stop.
The Owl looked low. The Owl looked up.
Between the trees, what could it be?

Inspired by a detail from: *Rosa Bonheur, Palette, 1800s.*



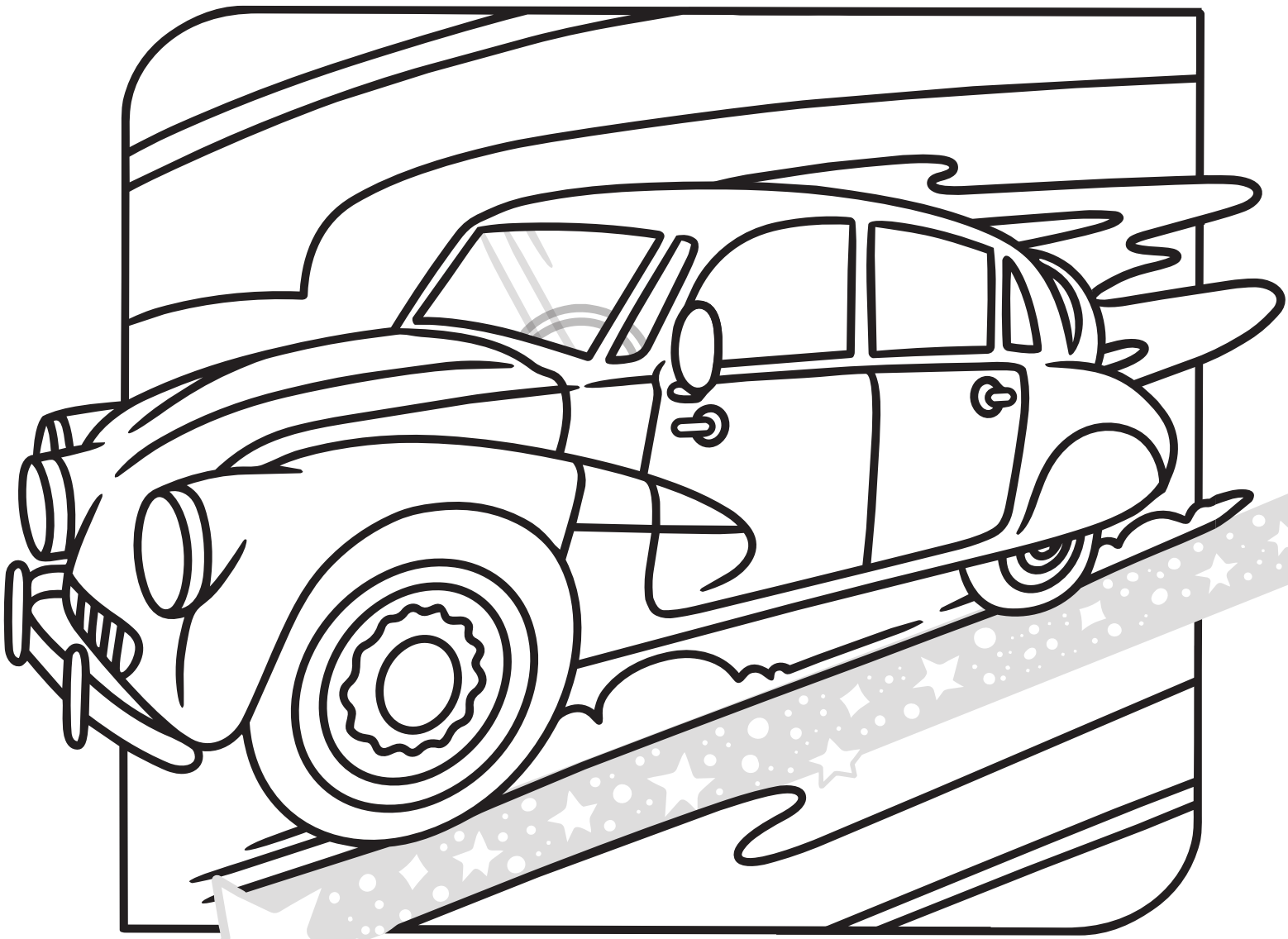
A deer came leaping, wild and free!

Inspired by: *The Pillsbury Owl, China, 1200s–1100s BCE.*



His wings were tired from his flight.
The Owl stopped there to rest that night.
He waited there beneath the moon...
In hopes a ride would find him soon.

Inspired by: *Hans Ledwinka, Tatra T87, 1948 (designed 1936).*



Then "Beep! Beep!" sounded loud and clear.
A Tatra car was drawing near!

Driver



Passenger



Who gets to drive? Who rides inside?
The final choice is yours. Decide!

Inspired by: *The Pillsbury Owl, China, 1200s–1100s BCE.*



By morning, all was back just right...
Or would the Owl take one more flight?

Meet the Art Behind the Adventure

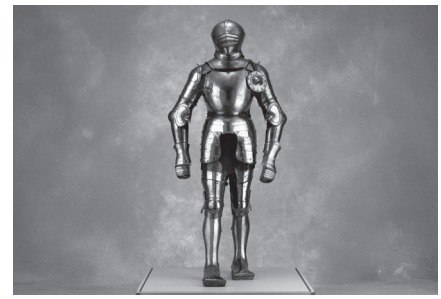
The Owl's adventure began with real works of art at Mia.
Can you spot the details that inspired the characters and places in this book?



Pillsbury Owl
China, 1200s-1100s BCE



A "Bear" Chance
Philip R. Goodwin, 1907
Can you spot the box?



Armor
Germany, about 1520



Baboon and Young
Pablo Picasso, 1951



Flock of Cranes
Ishida Yūtei, 1700s
Do these birds look noisy to you?



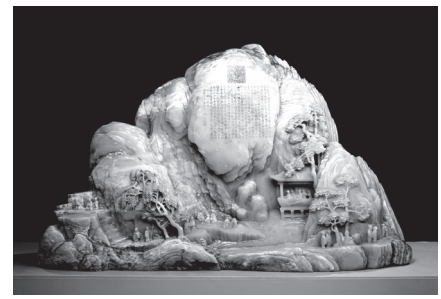
Helmet in Dragonfly Shape
Japan, 1600s



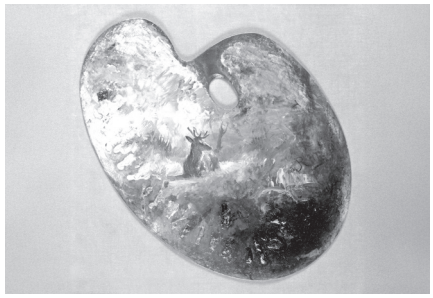
A Fishing Party Off Long Island
Junius Brutus Stearns, 1860



Horse
China, early 700s



Jade Mountain
China, 1790
Can you find the landscape?



Palette
Rosa Bonheur, 1800s
Can you spot the deer?



Tatra T87
Hans Ledwinka, 1948
(designed 1936)

Want to see the originals?

Find these works in the galleries at Mia.

See the art in color!





About the Artist

Ruth is a California based illustrator and coloring book artist known for bold lines, quirky characters and a fun easy to color style.

Her coloring books include **Just a Tad**, which follows Tad, a sad little frog trying to live his best life and **Over the Moon**, where Bovie the cow finds herself on an unexpected adventure after a mysterious alien abduction.

Ruth believes coloring can be a safe space, even when life feels overwhelming. Through her books and online content, she encourages others to slow down, be kind to themselves and take time to create.

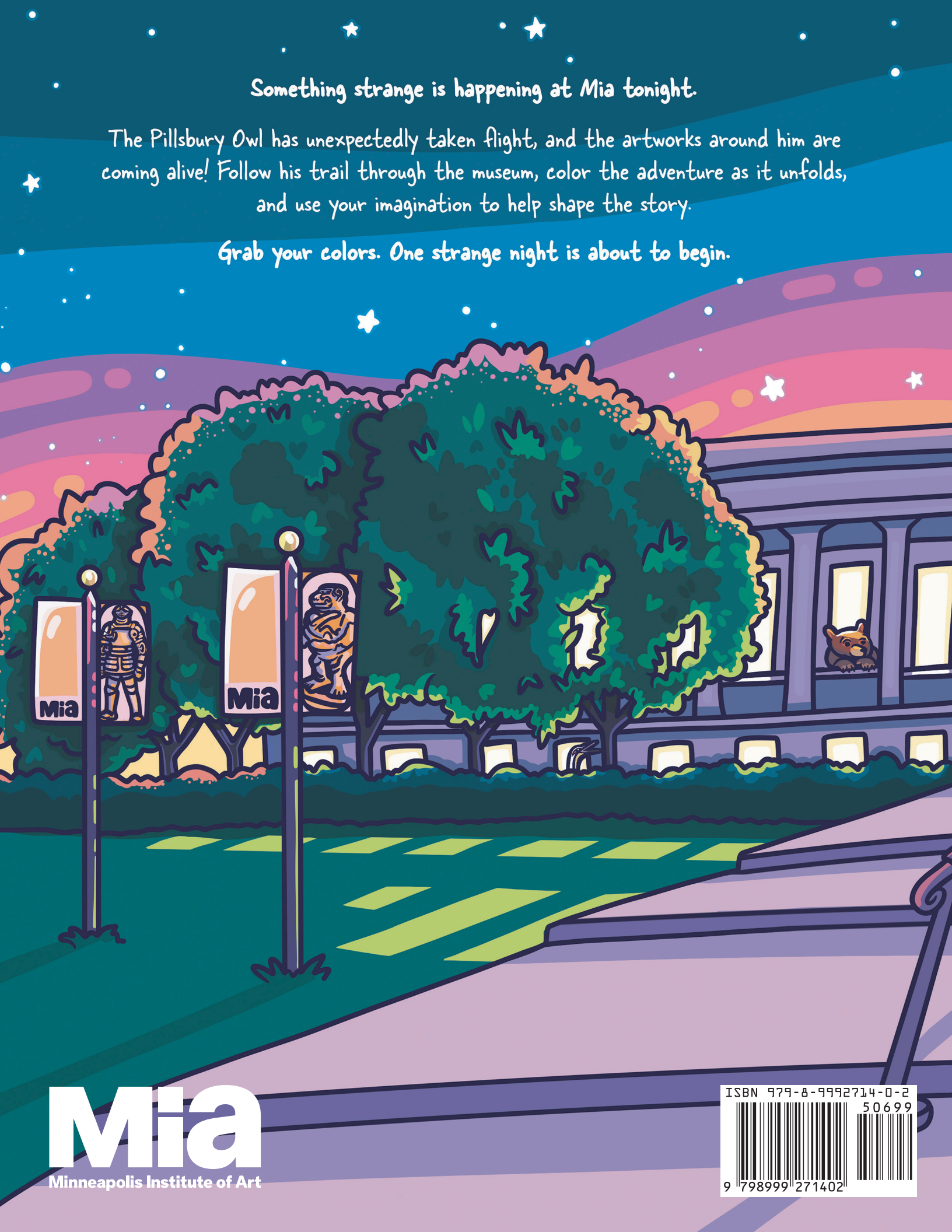
You can keep up with Ruth's latest work at:

www.RuthsColoring.com

Something strange is happening at Mia tonight.

The Pillsbury Owl has unexpectedly taken flight, and the artworks around him are coming alive! Follow his trail through the museum, color the adventure as it unfolds, and use your imagination to help shape the story.

Grab your colors. One strange night is about to begin.



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ISBN 979-8-9992714-0-2
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